

Data protection information for Catalyst

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Data protection information for Catalyst

The Max-Planck-Gesellschaft zur Förderung der Wissenschaften e.V. (MPG) takes the protection of your personal data very seriously. We process personal data gathered when using this app in compliance with the applicable data protection legislation and, as a matter of principle.

The initiative **Catalyst** offered by the Max-Planck-Institute for Intelligent Systems (MPI-IS) provides a website (<https://catalyst-app.org/>) and a web-app (<https://app.catalyst-app.org>).

A. Website

1. Visiting

a. Type of data

Each time you visit our website, our service and applications automatically record data and information from the system of the visiting device.

The following data are gathered temporarily:

- Your IP address
- Date and time of your access to the website
- Address of the page visited
- Address of the previously visited website (*referrer*)
- Name and version of your browser/operating system (if transmitted)

These data are stored in our systems' log files. There is no storage of these data together with other personal data relating to the user.

b. Legal basis

The legal basis for the temporary saving of data and log files is Article 6 (1) lit. f GDPR. Storage occurs in log files in order to ensure the website's functionality. The data also serve to optimize the websites, eliminate malfunctions and ensure our IT system security. Our justified interest in data processing pursuant to Article 6 (1) lit. f GDPR also lies in such purposes.

The recording of data for the provision of the website and the storage of data in log files are essential to operate the website. It is therefore not possible for the user to object.

c. Data deletion

The data are deleted as soon as they are no longer required in order to fulfil the purpose of their collection. If data are gathered for the provision of the website, this is the case if the respective visit is ended. In the event that data are stored in log files, this is the case after seven days at the latest. Storage above and beyond this period is possible. In this case, the users' IP addresses are deleted or removed so they can no longer be allocated to the visiting device.

2. No Cookies

Our website does not use cookies.

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B. Web-App

3. Visiting

d. Type of data

Each time you visit our web-app, our service and applications automatically record data and information from the system of the visiting device.

The following data are gathered temporarily:

- Your IP address
- Date and time of your access to the web-app
- Address of the page visited
- Address of the previously visited website (*referrer*)
- Name and version of your browser/operating system (if transmitted)

These data are stored in our systems' log files. There is no storage of these data together with other personal data relating to the user.

e. Legal basis

The legal basis for the temporary saving of data and log files is Article 6 (1) lit. f GDPR. Storage occurs in log files in order to ensure the web-app's functionality. The data also serve to optimize the webapps, eliminate malfunctions and ensure our IT system security. Our justified interest in data processing pursuant to Article 6 (1) lit. f GDPR also lies in such purposes.

The recording of data for the provision of the webapp and the storage of data in log files are essential to operate the webapp. It is therefore not possible for the user to object.

f. Data deletion

The data are deleted as soon as they are no longer required in order to fulfil the purpose of their collection. If data are gathered for the provision of the webapp, this is the case if the respective visit is ended. In the event that data are stored in log files, this is the case after seven days at the latest. Storage above and beyond this period is possible. In this case, the users' IP addresses are deleted or removed so they can no longer be allocated to the visiting device.

4. No Cookies

Our web-app does not use cookies.

5. Sign-Up

g. Type of data

Our web-app offers users the opportunity to sign up to Catalyst. When users sign up, the data from the input screen are transmitted to us. This consists of (mandatory):

- your email address
- your password
- your last name
- your first name

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- your institutional affiliations
- a set of keywords and topics of your scientific interests

And might consist of (optional):

- your career stage
- link to your personal website
- your photo
- longer description of your scientific interests

We inform you about the processing of your data during the sign-up process and obtain your consent accordingly via a tick-box. There is also a reference to this Data Privacy Statement. The personal data provided during the sign-up is enriched by the following data during the use of Catalyst:

- your collaborators based on queries to OpenAlex API
- your published papers based on queries to OpenAlex API
- referenced papers within your published papers based on queries to OpenAlex API
- your verification status
- your location based on your institutional affiliation

Again, we obtain your consent for the use of this data during the sign-up process.

h. Purpose

We collect the data for the purpose of:

- **Service Communication:** To contact you regarding your account (e.g., verification), service updates (e.g., newsletter on new features), or technical support.
- **Account Creation and Management:** Creating and managing your profile on our platform including all the information collected above.
- **API Queries:** To submit search queries to the OpenAlex API on your behalf, enriching your profile with your collaborators on published papers. To submit prompts via Huggingface API to a Llama LLM to generate an optional description of your research topic.
- **Scientific Analysis:** Data is used for analyzing scientific interests across disciplines, institutions and geographical circumstances. For scientific analyses the collected data will be pseudonymised or anonymised. Re-identification is not possible.
- **Authentication:** To verify your identity when you login on our web-app.
- **Matchmaking:** Based on your enriched profile we compile potential interesting matches among the registered users. A match consists of two registered users who we estimate a high likelihood of being mutually interested in each other for scientific collaboration. Your profile with the following information is shown to other users for whom we suggest that you are a potential match:
 - Your First and Last Name
 - Your Institutional Affiliation
 - Your set of keywords and topics of your interest

We do not use your personal data for marketing purposes, profiling, or automated decision-making.

i. Legal basis

The processing of the users' personal data is based on explicit consent. We provide the user this data protection information and require the user to click "I consent to the processing of my mandatory

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(email address, password, name, institutional affiliation, keywords of interest) and optional information (career stage, personal website, photo, description of scientific interests).” during the sign-up process. The users' interest in the protection of their personal data is sufficiently taken into account by technical and operational measures for data security and privacy.

j. Data deletion

The personal data is used to create a profile which is deleted based on request of the user, two years after the user has logged in the last time or twelve months after the end of the project Catalyst, unless they are archived for scientific purposes. The users' interest in the protection of their personal data is sufficiently taken into account by technical and operational measures for data security and privacy.

6. Login

k. Type of data

Our web-app offers users the opportunity to login to Catalyst. When users login, the data from the input screen are transmitted to us. This generally consists of:

- your email address
- your password
- a time stamp

We obtain your consent for the use of this data during the sign-up process.

l. Purpose

We collect the data for the purpose of:

- **Authentication:** To verify your identity when you login on our web-app.
- **User Experience Optimization:** To check the regularity of use of Catalyst.

We do not use your personal data for marketing purposes, profiling, or automated decision-making.

m. Legal basis

The processing of the users' personal data is based on explicit consent.

n. Data deletion

The personal data is associated to a profile which is deleted based on request of the user, two years after the user has logged in the last time or twelve months after the end of the project Catalyst, unless they are archived for scientific purposes. The users' interest in the protection of their personal data is sufficiently taken into account by technical and operational measures for data security and privacy.

7. Matchmaking

o. Type of data

Our web-app offers users the opportunity to match different signed-up users of Catalyst. When users login to Catalyst, they obtain a set of potential matches.

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We ask the user for preferences on suggested matches (including synthesized artificial mock users) with possible answers: “no interest”, “know already”, “interest”, “show me at some other point”. This data is stored alongside the profile.

We obtain your consent for the use of this data during the sign-up process.

p. Purpose

The data is collected for the purpose of:

- **User Preference Optimization:** Based on your revealed preferences we optimize for suggesting better fitting matches to you.
- **Scientific Analysis:** Data is used for analyzing matchmaking across disciplines, institutions and geographical circumstances. For scientific analyses the collected data will be pseudonymised or anonymised. Re-identification is not possible.

We do not use your personal data for marketing purposes, profiling, or automated decision-making.

q. Legal basis

The processing of the users' personal data is based on explicit consent.

r. Data deletion

The personal data is associated to a profile which is deleted based on request of the user, two years after the user has logged in the last time or twelve months after the end of the project Catalyst, unless they are archived for scientific purposes. The users' interest in the protection of their personal data is sufficiently taken into account by technical and operational measures for data security and privacy.

C. Data transmission

8. Management and Storage

The management and storage of your personal data is carried out by selected services

- Website (uberspace TODO)
- Web-App (MPI-IS)

within the scope of commissioned data processing on systems of our service providers.

Your personal data are only transmitted to public institutions and authorities if legally required or for the purpose of criminal prosecution due to attacks on our network infrastructure.

9. Data Sharing and Storage

Your personal data may be shared with the following third party:

- OpenAlex API
- HuggingFace API

We transmit your registration information (first name, last name, institutional affiliation, and email address) to the OpenAlex API to find collaborators of yours and refine your suggested matches. OpenAlex is an open-access bibliographic database. For information about how OpenAlex processes personal data, please refer to their privacy policy at: <https://openalex.org/>.

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We transmit your chosen keywords for your description to the HuggingFace API to generate a description of your research topic on your behalf. The inference request may be routed by HuggingFace to Novita AI to run the underlying model (Llama 3.1. instruct); in that case, the provider's own data handling terms also apply. HuggingFace and Novita do not use submitted data for training purposes. Novita AI operates on a "Zero Data Retention" privacy policy by default. HuggingFace does not store the request body or response when routing requests. Debug logs are retained by HuggingFace for up to 30 days. Please refer to HuggingFace's security documentation at: <https://huggingface.co/docs/inference-providers/en/security>, and to Novita AI's privacy policy at: <https://novita.ai/legal/privacy-policy>.

We do not sell, rent, or trade your personal data to any other third parties.

The data are not shared with third parties for any other purposes.

10. International Data Transfers

The OpenAlex API, the HuggingFace API, and the third-party inference provider it routes to (currently Novita AI) may process data outside the European Economic Area (EEA). Where this occurs, appropriate safeguards are relied on in accordance with Article 46 GDPR, including Standard Contractual Clauses and, where applicable, the EU-U.S. Data Privacy Framework.

D. General details

11. Ethics Approval

Ethics approval is not required as no sensitive personal data are processed.

12. Contact details of the controller

The controller within the meaning of the General Data Protection Regulation and other national data protection acts as well as other data protection legislation is the

Max-Planck-Gesellschaft zur Förderung der Wissenschaften e.V. (MPG)

Hofgartenstrasse 8

D-80539 Munich, Germany

Telephone: +49 (89) 2108-0

Contact form: <https://www.mpg.de/kontakt/anfragen>

Internet: <https://www.mpg.de>

13. Data Protection Officer's contact details

The controller's Data Protection Officer can be reached as follows:

Data Protection Officer of the MPG

Hofgartenstrasse 8

D-80539 Munich, Germany

Telephone: +49 (89) 2108-1554

datenschutz@mpg.de

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E. Rights of the data subjects

As a data subject whose personal data are collected in the context of the above-mentioned services, you generally have the following rights unless legal exceptions apply in individual cases:

- Information (Article 15 GDPR)
- Correction (Article 16 GDPR)
- Deletion (Article 17 (1) GDPR)
- Restriction of processing (Article 18 GDPR)
- Data transmission (Article 20 GDPR)
- Revocation of processing (Article 21 GDPR)
- Revocation of consent (Article 7 (3) GDPR)
- Right to data portability (???)
- Right to complain to the regulator (Article 77 GDPR). For the MPG, this is the Bavarian Data Protection Authority (BayLDA), Postfach 1349, 91504 Ansbach, Germany.

F. Changes to this statement

We may update this Data Protection Statement from time to time. We will notify you of any significant changes by posting the new statement on this page and updating the "Last Updated" date. We encourage you to review this statement periodically.